



Libby Prison mess kit

Although Libby Prison was severely overcrowded, Union captives held there were comparatively well treated. These items were issued to Colonel John S. Crocker of the 93rd New York Volunteers upon his arrival.

High mortality rates

Some 26,000 captured Confederates were held at one time or another in Camp Douglas, built originally as a training barracks. The camp was sited on a damp, low-lying bit of prairie outside Chicago. It earned the grim reputation of having a higher percentage of deaths in a single month than any other prison camp in the war—